

where do i get data?

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outline

where?

census data

good practices

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good practices

no need to collect—data everywhere

- used to be that you had to collect data yourself
 - some people still do it
- but almost always the data you need already collected
- it is not easy to collect/produce data
 - a separate degree or at least a class on how to do it
- data are everywhere
 - whatever you study, can get data for it

find data—the fast way

- email the listserv
- again, data questions are perfectly fine
- google/AI
- requires skill in knowing what to google/prompt

find data—the slow (classic) way: a website

- eg these `https://theaok.github.io/datManPy/intro.pdf#page=11.98` or census

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- i like `http://socialexplorer.com`
- (on campus or vpn)
- under most popular: ACS5yr: begin report

census website

- a similar interface on census website
- `https://data.census.gov/advanced`
- and click geographies on the left
- then at the top can search in box 'topic or table name'
- say for 'income'

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good practices

cite it!

- always cite your data
 - at least full name and **specific** url [not census.gov etc]
- i do not care about the format; eg
 - cite at the end among regular references
 - cite in text
 - have an appendix
 - cite in footnote

be careful about confidential data!

- anything that can be used to identify a person
 - ssn, dob, name, any ID #, etc
- just de-identify:
 - either drop sensitive vars
 - or create 2 files with your own new ID
 - one with sensitive info and ID, and keep it secure
 - the other with other info that you can easily carry around